

Santiago (Tigo) Ponce de León

Product Design Engineer — Chicago, Illinois

A designer who ships the code — research and product thinking through to React in production, in service of software that is both useful and pleasurable.

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experience

01	Vicino AI — UX Engineer Intern	Jun 2026 - Aug 2026	Bellevue, WA
	- Designing product experiences across key workflows for an AI-powered video and marketing platform, turning agentic creative concepts into user-centered interfaces. - Building front-end UI components in React, bridging Figma designs and production code to accelerate design-to-engineer handoff. - Shaping and documenting the platform's visual language and interaction patterns into a scalable component library used across feature pages.		
02	PantryPal — Product Designer and iOS Developer	Nov 2025 - Present	Chicago, IL
	- Designing and building an AI mobile app that turns the ingredients a household already owns into personalized recipes, cutting food waste through inventory reuse. - Writing the production iOS app in Swift and SwiftUI — designing and coding the same screens — with an App Store release targeted for August 2026. - Ran user interviews and moderated usability tests between design rounds, rebuilding ingredient entry and recipe matching around where people actually got stuck. - Built the design system behind the app: wireframes through high-fidelity UI, a documented component library, and interaction patterns now implemented in SwiftUI.		
03	University of Chicago — UX Researcher	Nov 2025 - Dec 2025	Chicago, IL
	- Ran an empirical study of visual and interaction patterns across six AI-generated recipe web apps to measure interface homogenization. - Deployed prototypes via GitHub Pages and authored the paper on how AI models operationalize a statistical consensus of product design convention.		
04	Next Level Drone Cleaning — Founding Visual Designer	Jul 2025 - Sep 2025	Kortrijk, Belgium
	- Designed the complete visual identity for an early-stage drone-tech startup from scratch: brand guidelines, logo suite, and collateral across web, print, and pitch. - Built the responsive marketing site (nextleveldronecleaning.be) with the founder, plus component libraries that held the team consistent without ongoing design help.		

education

—	University of Chicago — B.A. Media Arts & Design and Computer Science	Expected May 2027	Chicago, IL
	Coursework: Human-Computer Interaction, Internet Art & Web Design, Visual Systems		
	Honors: Spain Foreign Language Acquisition Grant — study in Madrid, Summer 2025		

skills

product	User Research	Wireframing	Interaction Design	Design Systems	Usability Testing			
engineering	Swift	SwiftUI	React	HTML / CSS / JavaScript	Python	C#	Git	Xcode
design	Figma	Prototyping	Adobe Creative Cloud					
languages	Spanish — professional working	English — fluent						